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Emacs Tab Bar

Operation	Keystroke	Function	Note
Emacs Tab Bar Emacs >= 27.1 Last updated on:	**Emacs 27.1** introduced a tab bar that is quite useful to maintain an Emacs window "*context*". PEL key bindings for the management of tab bar are placed within the pel:window prefix, some are inside the PEL **pel-∑window/** window **hydra** in **∑ Windows** 2026-10-09		Note: several commands an key bindings were introduced in Emacs 28 and later. They are not yet all documented here.🚧
Open this PDF file. See also: **∑ Help/Info**	`M-<f11> M-= <f1>`	(**pel-help-pdf** &optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)	Open the **∑ Tab Bar** local PDF. With `C-u` , `M--`, `M- -1` or `C- -1` prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the **pel-flip-help-pdf-arg** user-option is set it's the other way around.
∑ Customize Emacs Tab Bar control	`M-<f11> M-= <f3>`	(**pel-customize-library** &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Customize Emacs tab bar management support.
Toggle tab-bar-mode	`M-<f11> M-= M-= <f7> w M-T`	(**tab-bar-mode** &optional ARG)	Toggle the tab bar in all frames. ☝See **pel-∑window/** window **hydra** in **∑ Windows** for Emacs >= 27.1
Create/delete tabs			
Do following command inside a new tab Emacs >= 28.1	`C-x t t` `M-<f11> M-= M-,`	(**other-tab-prefix**)	Display the buffer of the next command in a new tab. • Creates a new tab before displaying the buffer, or switches to the tab that already contains that buffer. • The next buffer is the buffer displayed by the next command invoked immediately after this command (ignoring reading from the minibuffer). • When '**switch-to-buffer-obey-display-actions**' is non-nil, '**switch-to-buffer**' commands are also supported.

Create a new tab	`C-x t 2`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-\`
	`⌘-t`
		• (**tab-bar-new-tab** &optional ARG FROM-NUMBER)
		• (**tab-new** &optional ARG FROM-NUMBER)
			Create a new tab ARG positions to the right. If a negative ARG, create a new tab ARG positions to the left.
			• If ARG is zero, create a new tab in place of the current tab.
			• If no ARG is specified, then add a new tab at the position specified by '**tab-bar-new-tab-to**'.
			• Argument addressing is relative in contrast to '**tab-bar-new-tab-to**', where argument addressing is absolute.
			• If FROM-NUMBER is a tab number, a new tab is created from that tab.

Duplicate tab retaining same window layout
Emacs >= 28.1
	`C-x t n`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-|`
	`⌘-T`
		• (**tab-bar-duplicate-tab** &optional ARG FROM-NUMBER)
		• (**tab-duplicate** &optional ARG FROM-NUMBER)
			Clone the current tab to ARG positions to the right (or left with negative ARG).
			• If ARG is zero, create a new tab in place of the current tab.
			• If no ARG is specified, then add a new tab at the position specified by '**tab-bar-new-tab-to**'.
			• Argument addressing is relative in contrast to '**tab-bar-new-tab-to**', where argument addressing is absolute.
			• If FROM-NUMBER is a tab number, a new tab is created from that tab.

Tear window in tab bar
See: ∑ Windows
	`C-x w ^ t`
	`• <f11> w i t`
	`✱ <f7> w T`
		(**tab-window-detach**)	Move the selected window to a new **tab**.
			• This command removes the selected window from the configuration stored on the current tab, and makes a new tab with that window in its configuration.

Create a tab for specified buffer	`C-x t b` `M-<f11> M-= M-b`	(**switch-to-buffer-other-tab** BUFFER-OR-NAME)	Prompt for a buffer and switch to buffer BUFFER-OR-NAME in another tab.

Visit a file in a new tab	`C-x t f`
	`C-x t C-f`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-f`
		(**find-file-other-tab** FILENAME &optional WILDCARDS)	Prompt for FILENAME. , edit file FILENAME, in another tab.
			• If WILDCARDS is non-nil, FILENAME can include widcards, and all matching files will be visited.

Open a dired buffer for specified directory	`C-x t f`
	`C-x t C-f`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-d`
		(**dired-other-tab** DIRNAME &optional SWITCHES)	"Edit" directory DIRNAME. Like 'dired' but make a new tab.

Close tab	`C-x t 0`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-c`
	`⌘-w`
	`<f7> w C-t`
		(**tab-close** &optional TAB-NUMBER TO-NUMBER)	Close the tab specified by its absolute position TAB-NUMBER.
			• If no TAB-NUMBER is specified, then close the current tab and switch to the tab specified by 'tab-bar-close-tab-select'.
			• Interactively, TAB-NUMBER is the prefix numeric argument, and defaults to 1.
			• TAB-NUMBER counts from 1.
			• Optional TO-NUMBER could be specified to override the value of 'tab-bar-close-tab-select' programmatically with a position of an existing tab to select after closing the current tab.
			• TO-NUMBER counts from 1.

Close all other tabs	`C-x t 1` `M-<f11> M-= M-C`	(**tab-close-other** &optional TAB-NUMBER)	Close all tabs on the selected frame, except the tab TAB-NUMBER. TAB-NUMBER counts from 1 and defaults to the current tab (which happens interactively).
Close tab by name	`M-<f11> M-= M-k`	(**tab-bar-close-tab-by-name** NAME)	Prompt for the tab name and close it.
Restore most recently closed tab	`M-<f11> M-= M-u`	(**tab-undo**)	Restore the most recently closed tab.
Navigate across tabs	Move across (select) the tabs in the current Emacs frame with the following commands. • PEL supports shortcut keys for Emacs running in graphics mode on macOS using the `Fn` key which it configures as the Hyper modifier. This is not available when emacs is running in terminal mode.		

Select tab by number	`⌘-1`
	`… … …`
	`⌘-9`
	`M-1 M-<f11> M-t`
	`… … …`
	`M-9 M-<f11> M-t`
		(**tab-select**)	On macOS with Emacs running in graphical mode, PEL dynamically sets the tab-bar-select-tab-modifiers user-option variable to '(super) , which effectively activates these quick ⌘ key bindings. This is similar to macOS Safari tab keys.
			On other systems, and for Emacs running in terminal mode, use numeric prefix argument key(s) followed by M-<f11> M-t. This provides the extra flexibility of being able to select a larger range of tabs; you can compose an integer using numeric prefix argument keys.

Select next tab	`M-<f11> M-= M-]`
	`⌘-}`
	`C-<tab>`
		(**tab-next** &optional ARG)	Switch to next tab.
			• With n numeric prefix argument select next ARG tab

Select previous tab	`C-x t 0`
	`M-<f11> M-= M-[`
	`⌘-{`
	`C-S-<tab>`
		(**tab-previous** &optional ARG)	

Select last tab	`M-<f11> M-= M-l`	(**tab-last** &optional ARG)	Switch to the last tab or ARGth tab from the end of the tab bar. • Interactively, ARG is the prefix numeric argument; it defaults to 1, which means the last tab on the tab bar. For example, `C-u 2` or `M-2` prefix selects the tab before the last tab.
Select recent tab	`M-<f11> M-= M-r`	(**tab-recent** &optional ARG)	Switch to ARGth most recently visited tab. • Interactively, ARG is the prefix numeric argument and defaults to 1.
Select tab by name • **Possibly create it**	`C-x t RET` `M-<f11> M-= M-s`	(**tab-switch** NAME)	Switch to the tab by NAME. • Default values are tab names sorted by recency, so you can use `M-n` to get the name of the most recently visited tab, the second most recent, and so on. • When the tab with that NAME doesn't exist, create a new tab and rename it to NAME.
Manage tabs			
Rename a tab	`M-<f11> M-= M-a`	(**tab-rename** NAME &optional TAB-NUMBER)	Give the tab specified by its absolute position TAB-NUMBER a new NAME. • If no TAB-NUMBER is specified, then rename the current tab. • Interactively, TAB-NUMBER is the prefix numeric argument, and defaults to the current tab. • TAB-NUMBER counts from 1. • Interactively, prompt for the new NAME. • If NAME is the empty string, then use the automatic name function '**tab-bar-tab-name-function**'.

Operation	Keystroke	Function	Note
Move tab to the right/left	`C-x t m` `M-<f11> M-= M-m`	(**tab-move** &optional ARG)	Move the current tab ARG positions to the right. • Interactively, ARG is the prefix numeric argument and defaults to 1. • If ARG is negative, move the current tab ARG positions to the left. • Argument addressing is relative in contrast to '**tab-bar-move-tab-to**', where argument addressing is absolute.
Restore tab previous window configuration	`M-<f11> M-= M-p`	(**tab-bar-history-back**)	Restore a previous window configuration used in the current tab. • This navigates back in the history of window configurations.
Cancel restoration of tab window layout	`M-<f11> M-= M-n`	(**tab-bar-history-forward**)	Cancel restoration of the previous window configuration. • This navigates forward in the history of window configurations.
Σ Project aware commands in another tab			
	`C-x t p`	(**project-other-tab-command**)	Run project command, displaying resultant buffer in a new tab. The command is selected by the next key, shown below. • See **Σ Project** for more information about the specific project commands.

C-b	project-list-buffers
!	project-shell-command
&	project-async-shell-command
D	project-dired
F	project-or-external-find-file
G	project-or-external-find-regexp
b	project-switch-to-buffer
c	project-compile
d	project-find-dir
e	project-eshell
f	project-find-file
g	project-find-regexp
k	project-kill-buffers
o	project-any-command
p	project-switch-project
r	project-query-replace-regexp
s	project-shell
v	project-vc-dir
x	project-execute-extended-command